



# SQF Fundamentals Audit Edition 1.1

Spices, Inc. - 104320

## Summary

**Audit Decision**

Certified

**Certificate Number**

104320

**Audit Rating**

P

**Decision Date**

May 7, 2026

**Audit Type**

Initial Certification

**Recertification Date**

April 17, 2027

**On-Site Audit Dates**

April 17, 2026 - April 17, 2026

Pass

**Expiration Date**

July 1, 2027

**ICT Dates**

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**Issue Date**

May 7, 2026

## Facility and Scope

**Spices, Inc. - 104320**

315 Point Township Dr  
Northumberland, PA 17857 United States

**Products**

Dried Spices, Herbs and Seasoning Blends

**Food Sector Categories**

19. Food Ingredient Manufacturing

**Scope of Certification**

Blending, processing, packaging, storage, and distribution

## Certification Body and Audit Team

**EAGLE Food Registrations, Inc.**

220 E Monument Ave  
510  
Dayton, OH 45402-1287 United States

**CB#:** 40756

**Accreditation Body:** ANAB

**Accreditation Number:** 894

**Lead Auditor:** Cleo Pointer (C-376342)

**Technical Reviewer:** Christina Ramsey (C-427351)

**Hours Spent on Site:** 8

**Hours of ICT Activities:**

**Hours Spent Writing Report:** 6

## Section Responses

### Audit Statement - Audit

**SQF Practitioner Name** - Name the designated SQF Practitioner

**Response:** Glenna DePoe

**SQF Practitioner Email** - Email of the designated SQF Practitioner

**Response:** glenna@spicesinc.com

**Opening Meeting** - People Present at the Opening Meeting (Please list names and roles in the following format Name: Role separated by commas)

**Response:** Glenna DePoe, COO. Cheyenne Derk, QA Manager. Penny Paterson, SQF Project Manager. Greg Patterson, CEO. Arlen Keller, Consultant.

**Facility Description** - Auditor Description of Facility (Please provide facility description include # of employees, size, production schedule, general layout, and any additional pertinent details)

**Response:** Spices Inc. is a family-owned spice manufacturer and distributor specializing in fresh-ground spices, herbs, seasoning blends, chili powders, and private-label/custom formulations. The facility occupies approximately 16,000 square feet and employs 18 staff members. Operations run one shift, Monday through Friday, from 8:00 a.m. to 4:00 p.m. The site is located in a mixed commercial area in Northumberland, Pennsylvania, bordered by a restaurant and a retail store. These neighboring businesses pose no food safety or quality risk to Spices Inc.'s operations due to the absence of shared processes.

**Closing Meeting** - People Present at the Closing Meeting (Please list names and roles in the following format Name: Role separated by commas)

**Response:** Glenna DePoe, COO. Cheyenne Derk, QA Manager. Penny Paterson, SQF Project Manager. Greg Patterson, CEO. Rob Patterson, CRO. Arlen Keller, Consultant.

**Auditor Recommendation** - Auditor Recommendation

**Response:** Issue SQF certificate once all nonconformances have been satisfactorily corrected, verified, and formally closed.

### 2.1.1 - Food Safety Policy

**2.1.1.1** - Senior site management shall prepare and implement a policy statement that outlines as a minimum the:  
i. The site's commitment to supply safe food; ii. Methods used to comply with its customer and regulatory requirements, and iii. The site's commitment to establish and review food safety objectives.

**Response:** Compliant

**Summary** -

**Response:** The site maintains a Food Safety Commitment Policy dated 3/7/2025, signed by the Chief Operations Officer. The policy is written in English and is prominently posted in the breakroom and at the time clock. It reinforces the company's dedication to continuous improvement, resource support, and the sustainment of a strong food safety and quality culture.

## 2.1.2 - Management Responsibility

**2.1.2.1** - The reporting structure describing those who have responsibility for food safety shall be documented, identified and communicated within the site.

**Response:** Compliant

**2.1.2.2** - The senior site management shall make provision to ensure fundamental food safety practices and all applicable requirements of the SQF System are adopted and maintained.

**Response:** Compliant

**2.1.2.3** - The senior site management shall ensure adequate resources are available to achieve food safety objectives and support the development, implementation, maintenance and ongoing improvement of the SQF System.

**Response:** Compliant

**2.1.2.4** - Senior site management shall designate a person responsible for each site with responsibility and authority to: i. Lead the development and implementation of Good Manufacturing Practices (GMP) outlined in 2.4.2; ii. Oversee the development, implementation, review and maintenance of the SQF System; and iii. Take appropriate action to ensure the integrity of the SQF System.

**Response:** Compliant

**2.1.2.5** - The person responsible designated under 2.1.2.4 shall: i. Be fully employed or contracted by the site as a company employee/contractor; ii. Hold a position of responsibility in relation to the management of the site's SQF System; iii. Be competent to implement and maintain food safety fundamentals; and iv. Have an understanding of the SQF Food Safety Fundamentals and the requirements to implement and maintain SQF System relevant to the site's scope of certification.

**Response:** Compliant

**2.1.2.6** - Job descriptions for those responsible for food safety shall be documented and include provision to cover for the absence of key personnel.

**Response:** Compliant

### Summary -

**Response:** SOP 2.1.2 Management Responsibility Rev.12/8/2025. The facility maintains a clear and documented organizational structure that supports the development, implementation, and ongoing maintenance of the SQF System. Roles and responsibilities for food safety are formally assigned, including the SQF Practitioner and backup SQFP, with site management providing oversight and ensuring adequate resources for program execution. All designated personnel are HACCP trained and competent to perform their assigned duties. The SQF Practitioner is a full-time, trained employee with the authority to develop, maintain, and review the SQF System, including conducting required system reviews. A Food Safety Commitment Policy, signed by senior leadership, affirms the company's dedication to regulatory and customer compliance, continuous improvement, and sustaining a strong food safety and quality culture. Food safety culture is reinforced through management discussions and integration into the weekly CORE 4 meeting with the owners. Job descriptions for key personnel were reviewed and found to be current and aligned with position expectations. The organizational chart, dated 8/19/2025, reflects the current reporting structure and designated food safety responsibilities.

### 2.1.3 - Management Review

**2.1.3.1** - The senior site management shall be responsible for reviewing the SQF System and documenting the policy statement.

**Response:** Compliant

**2.1.3.2** - The SQF System in its entirety shall be reviewed at least annually.

**Response:** Compliant

**2.1.3.3** - The SQF System, and other aspects of Good Manufacturing Practices (GMP) shall be reviewed and updated as needed when any potential changes implemented have an impact on the site's ability to deliver safe food.

**Response:** Compliant

**2.1.3.4** - All changes made to Good Manufacturing Practices (GMP) and other aspects of the SQF System shall be validated or justified.

**Response:** Compliant

**2.1.3.5** - Records of all reviews, validations and changes to the SQF System shall be maintained.

**Response:** Compliant

#### Summary -

**Response:** The facility conducts its Management Review annually, with participation from the Owners, QA Manager, Operations Manager, and Inventory Control Manager. The most recent meeting was held on April 9, 2026. The review covered all required program elements, including the Food Safety Policy, HACCP Plan, Pre-Requisite Programs, Internal Audit results, Allergen Management, Customer Complaints, cGMP compliance, Training, and Supplier Approval.

### 2.1.4 - Complaint Management

**2.1.4.1** - The methods and responsibility for handling and investigating the cause and resolution of complaints from customers and authorities, arising from products manufactured or handled on site, shall be documented and implemented.

**Response:** Compliant

**2.1.4.2** - Records of customer complaints and their investigations shall be maintained.

**Response:** Compliant

#### Summary -

**Response:** SOP 2.1.4 Complaint Management Rev. 12/8/2025 outlines the site's process for receiving, handling, investigating, and resolving customer complaints. The Customer Complaint (CC) system is jointly maintained by Customer Service and QA. As part of this review, the following complaint record was evaluated: Complaint #52487. Reason: Brown M powder reported as too bitter. CAPA Result: Identified as a supplier QA issue. Status: Complaint investigated and closed. Record Location: Logged in the Product Incident Report Register – 2026. The Complaint Register for 2025–2026 was reviewed and found to contain the required entries in accordance with the site's complaint management procedure.

### 2.1.5 - Crisis Management Planning

**2.1.5** - Not applicable for SQF Fundamentals for Manufacturing – Intermediate

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • Not Applicable

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**Summary -**

**Response:** Not Applicable.

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## 2.2.1 - Food Safety Manual

**2.2.1.1** - A food safety manual shall be documented and maintained in either electronic and/or hard copy form and include or reference the written procedures, pre-requisite programs and other documentation necessary to support the development and the implementation, maintenance and control of the SQF System.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 2.2.1 Food Safety Manual Rev. 12/8/2025. The FSM is maintained in both electronic and hard copy formats. Its scope includes all raw materials, ingredients, packaging, processing activities, storage, distribution, prerequisite programs, and finished products. The FSM is maintained in both electronic and hard copy formats. Its scope includes all raw materials, ingredients, packaging, processing activities, storage, distribution, prerequisite programs, and finished products. Manual Content and Structure: -Food Safety Policy. -Organizational Structure. -Documented Procedures. -HACCP-based Food Safety Plan. -Product and Process Descriptions. -Verification and Validation Activities. -Recordkeeping and Document Control.

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## 2.2.2 - Document Control

**2.2.2.1** - Documents shall be controlled in a manner that ensures employees use up to date and current policies, procedures and forms when food safety related activities are documented.

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.2.2.2** - A register of current SQF System documents and amendments to documents shall be maintained.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 2.2.2 Document Control Rev. 12/8/2025 defines the site's system for maintaining controlled documents, including a Master List that identifies all current, approved versions. The procedure requires that obsolete documents are removed from use and archived in an Obsolete Document file to prevent unintended reference. A Central Document Register is maintained and includes required elements from Modules 2 and 11, ensuring alignment with SQF documentation expectations. All updates and changes to SOPs are documented, providing full traceability of revisions and supporting version control, accuracy, and audit readiness.

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## 2.2.3 - Records

**2.2.3.1** - All records shall be legible and suitably authorized by those undertaking monitoring activities that demonstrate inspections, analyses and other essential activities have been completed.

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.2.3.2** - Records shall be readily accessible, retrievable, securely stored to prevent damage and deterioration and shall be retained in accordance with periods specified by a customer or regulations.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 2.2.3 Records Rev.12/8/2025 defines the responsibilities of the SQF Practitioner for verifying all monitoring records to ensure they meet customer, regulatory, and legal requirements, including compliance with the site's documented record retention period. During the review, all records were found to be legible, accurate, and properly maintained in accordance with the procedure. The site maintains a documented retention schedule and retains all records for 3 years.

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### 2.3.1 - Product Development and Realization

**2.3.1** - Not applicable for SQF Fundamentals for Manufacturing - Intermediate

**Response:** N/A

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### 2.3.2 - Raw and Packaging Materials

**2.3.2.1** - Specifications for raw materials and packaging materials including, but not limited to ingredients, additives, hazardous chemicals and processing aids, that impact on finished product safety shall be documented, comply with relevant legislation, and kept current.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 2.3.2 Raw and Packaging Materials Rev. 1/29/2026. Raw Materials. -The Raw Material Specification for Jamaica Jerk Seasoning (Item #100268) dated 9/12/2024 was reviewed and found to be complete, current, and maintained under document control. Specification elements—including product characteristics, storage requirements, allergen status, and analytical/microbiological parameters—were verified as present and consistent with SOP 2.3.2 requirements. Packaging Materials. -All packaging materials are received exclusively from approved suppliers listed on the current Approved Supplier Register. Certificates of Compliance (CoC) or equivalent guarantee letters are received from packaging suppliers to verify conformance to established specifications and regulatory requirements. Packaging specifications were confirmed to be maintained, current, and reviewed as required by SOP 2.3.2.

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### 2.3.3 - Contract Service Providers

**2.3.3** - Not applicable for SQF Fundamentals for Manufacturing - Intermediate

**Response:** N/A

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### 2.3.4 - Contract Manufacturers

**2.3.4** - Not applicable for SQF Fundamentals for Manufacturing - Intermediate

**Response:** N/A

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### 2.3.5 - Finished Product

**2.3.5.1** - Finished product specifications shall be documented, current, approved by the site and their customer, accessible to relevant staff and may include: iii. Microbiological and chemical limits; and iv. Labeling and packaging requirements.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 2.3.5 Finished Product Rev. 3/23/2026 governs the controls applied to finished blended products to ensure they meet all customer, regulatory, and internal quality requirements. The Quality Unit is responsible for verifying that finished products conform to approved customer specifications, including all analytical, microbiological, and labeling criteria. This includes confirming that all required testing is completed, results meet specification limits, and any deviations are evaluated and addressed prior to release. The procedure ensures that finished blended products are consistently produced, verified, and documented in a manner that supports product safety, legality, and customer satisfaction. Reviewed: Mexican Oregano Spec. Item: -100259. Date: -4/4/2025. Elements: -Country of Origin. -Appearance. -Flavor. Storage. -Shelf Life. -Product Certs. -Micro and Chemical Properties.

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#### 2.4.1 - Food Legislation

**2.4.1.1** - The site shall ensure that, at the time of delivery to its customer, the food supplied shall comply with the legislation that applies to the food and its production in the country of its origin and destination if known. This includes compliance with legislative requirements applicable to maximum residue limits, food safety, packaging, product description; net weights, nutritional, allergen and additive labeling, any other criteria listed under food safety legislation, and to relevant established industry codes of practice.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 2.4.1 Food Legislation Rev. 1/29/2026. The QA Manager/SQF Practitioner ensures that site management and staff remain informed of regulatory changes, food safety issues, and industry codes of practice through routine updates from Food Trade Associations (e.g., the American Spice Trade Association), FDA alerts, and SQFI newsletters. These communication channels support continuous awareness of emerging risks, regulatory expectations, and industry best practices relevant to the site's operations. SQFI and the Certification Body (CB) are identified as essential regulatory contacts. The site is required to notify both SQFI and the CB in writing within 24 hours of any regulatory warning, enforcement action, or food safety event that may impact product safety or compliance.

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#### 2.4.2 - Food Safety Fundamentals

**2.4.2.1** - The site shall ensure the practices described in the relevant subsequent modules of this Code are applied or exempted according to a risk analysis outlining the justification for exclusion or evidence of the effectiveness of alternative control measures to ensure that food safety is not compromised.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 2.4.2 Food Safety Fundamentals Rev. 2/11/2026 covers implementation, scope and maintenance of cGMPs and Food Safety and aligns with the requirements outlined in Modules 2 and 11.

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### 2.4.3 - Food Safety Plan

**2.4.3.1** - The site shall have a HACCP-based reference Food Safety plan, developed by a responsible authority to meet regulatory and customer requirements or has developed their own plan following the Codex Alimentarius model. The site's written food safety plan shall include at minimum: i. An established a multi-disciplinary food safety team; ii. A description of the product and product category of all ingredients (including raw materials, packaging, finished product) and the required conditions for storage and distribution; iii. A description of the intended use of the product and identify the target consumer; iv. A description of all of the steps taken to produce the product in a process flow diagram; and v. A comparison of the process flow diagram with the production process to ensure it is accurate.

**Response:** Compliant

**2.4.3.2** - The site shall perform a hazard analysis of their food manufacturing process as a minimum step in order to determine if there are any hazards associated with the production of their food item. The site shall use the HACCP tool to accomplish this assessment. If hazards are identified within the manufacturing process, it is expected that the business will take appropriate action necessary to develop a HACCP Plan. The hazard analysis shall be conducted for each process step in the manufacturing of the food item.

**Response:** Compliant

**2.4.3.3** - If the hazard analysis indicates any significant hazards not minimized or eliminated by Good Manufacturing Practices (GMPs) that are present within the food manufacturing process, they shall be identified as Critical Control Points (CCPs). The site shall ensure the following for each CCP: i. Critical Limits are established for each CCP; ii. Monitoring procedures are established for each CCP; iii. CCPs are effectively implemented; and iv. Corrective actions are established for each CCP in the event critical limits are exceeded.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not have CCPs.

**2.4.3.4** - Verification procedures shall be established and effectively implemented.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not have CCP's.

**2.4.3.5** - Record keeping and documentation for all HACCP-related procedures shall be established and effectively implemented.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not have CCPs.

**2.4.3.6** - The site shall have implemented specific control measures for all relevant steps not identified as CCPs.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not have CCPs established.

#### Summary -

**Response:** SOP 2.4.3 Food Safety Plan Rev. 3/16/2026. The site maintains a HACCP Program in which no CCPs have been identified, as all reasonably foreseeable biological, chemical, and physical hazards are effectively controlled through robust prerequisite programs (PRPs). These PRPs include sanitation, allergen management, personnel hygiene practices, and a documented supplier verification program. Incoming materials are controlled through approved suppliers, COAs, and specification reviews, ensuring hazards are



mitigated prior to receipt. A structured hazard evaluation decision tree is used to assess risks across preventive controls, supply chain activities, weighing and blending, sanitation and allergen management, packaging, and labeling. This evaluation confirms that PRPs provide sufficient control without the need for CCPs. The Food Safety Team consists of the Owners, QA Manager, Inventory Control Manager, and Data Analyst, meeting quarterly to review the HACCP Program. The most recent review on 3/19/2026 verified that PRPs remain effective and appropriate in lieu of CCPs, and that the hazard analysis continues to support a no-CCP determination. Core PRP Controls. 1. Control of Biological, Chemical & Physical Hazards. Managed through sanitation, equipment conditions, personnel practices, and environmental controls. Daily monitoring and verification activities ensure PRPs remain effective. 2. Safety of Incoming Materials. Controlled through supplier approval, Certificates of Analysis, and product specifications. Incoming materials are verified to meet safety and quality requirements before use. 3. Cross-Contamination & Allergen Cross-Contact Prevention. Controlled through sanitation programs, allergen management, zoning, and personnel hygiene practices. Allergen controls include labeling checks, separation, and validated cleaning. 4. Risk Analysis. All hazards are evaluated through PRPs and the site's decision tree. PRPs are deemed sufficient to prevent, eliminate, or reduce hazards to acceptable levels. Hazard Assessment & Decision Tree Use. The site uses a formal decision tree to determine whether hazards are significant and whether additional controls are required. The assessment includes the following elements: -Preventive Controls. -Supply Chain Controls. -Weighing & Blending Controls. -Allergen & Sanitation Controls. -Packaging Controls. -Labeling Controls.

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#### 2.4.4 - Approved Supplier Program

**2.4.4.1** - Raw materials, ingredients, packaging materials, and services that impact on finished product safety shall meet the agreed specification (2.3.2) and be supplied by an approved supplier.

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.4.4.2** - Inspections and analyses shall conform to standard reference methods.

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.4.4.3** - Records of inspections and analyses shall be maintained.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** SOP Approved Supplier Program Rev. 3/16/2026. All raw materials, ingredients, packaging materials, and safety impacting services are sourced from approved suppliers and verified through COAs, COCs, physical inspections, sensory checks, and chemical or microbiological testing. Supplier approval requires completion of a Vendor Questionnaire, and supporting documentation, product specifications, ingredient statements, country of origin, allergen declarations, nutritional information, SDS, Letters of Continuing Guarantee, and sample COAs are collected and reviewed prior to approval. Reviewed: Supplier Register: -2025-2026. Reviewed: Spice Suppliers. -Matahari Spice/Illinois. -Atlantic Spice/Mass. -2026.

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#### 2.4.5 - Non-conforming Product or Equipment

**2.4.5.1** - Non-conforming product, raw material, ingredient, work-in-progress, packaging or equipment shall be quarantined, handled, re-worked or disposed of in a manner that minimizes the risk of inadvertent use, improper use or risk to the integrity of finished product.

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.4.5.2** - Records of the handling and disposal of non-conforming product shall be maintained.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP Non-conforming Product or Equipment Rev. 2/11/2026. The facility's nonconformance procedure defines how the site identifies, controls, and resolves nonconformances involving ingredients, packaging, finished products, and equipment. All affected product or material is immediately isolated in the designated quarantine area and marked with 'Hold' identification tags to prevent accidental use or release. Reviewed: NM Chili Powder. Hold# 100.338. Lot# BQ16L25. Reason: -Rancid. Disposition: -Product discarded. All NC products are entered into the Product Incident log.

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## 2.4.6 - Product Rework

**2.4.6.1** - Rework (recycle or regroup) activities shall be controlled and traceability ensured.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 2.4.6 Rework Rev. 2/11/2026. The site maintains a designated quarantine area within the warehouse for all rework material and nonconforming products. Any material identified for rework or evaluation is immediately segregated, labeled, and moved to this controlled area to prevent unintended use. All rework material is entered into the Product Incident Report (PIR) Log, which serves as the formal record for tracking, investigation, and disposition. Rework involves "like to like" same-day product.

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## 2.4.7 - Product Release

**2.4.7.1** - The responsibility and methods for releasing products shall be documented and implemented. The methods applied shall ensure the product is released: i. By authorized personnel; and ii. Once all inspections and analyses are successfully completed and documented to verify legislative and other established food safety controls have been met.

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.4.7.2** - Records of all product release shall be maintained.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 2.4.7 Release Rev. 3/18/2025. The QA Manager and the Inventory Manager are responsible for all releases. The releases are recorded in an electronic database program.

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## 2.4.8 - Environmental Monitoring

**2.4.8.1** - A risk-based environmental monitoring program shall be in place for all food manufacturing processes and consider the following: i. Applicable pathogens or indicator organisms; ii. Number and location of samples to be taken; and iii. Frequency of sampling.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** The Environmental Monitoring Program SOP 2.4.8 Rev. 3/17/2026 is risk-based and supported by a formal site risk assessment that was completed on 1/23/2026. The program includes routine swabbing of Zones 2–4, with frequencies established according to risk: Zone 2 bi-monthly, Zone 3 quarterly, and Zone 4 semi-annually. All environmental samples are analyzed using the Hygiena MicroSnap system. Sampling, Results, and Corrective Actions. -Environmental samples collected on 4/1/2026 were reviewed and found acceptable. In the event of a failure, the affected area is cleaned, sanitized, and retested to verify restoration of hygienic control. Control Measures. The site relies on Sanitation and GMPs as primary control measures supporting the EMP and maintaining environmental conditions that minimize the risk of contamination.

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#### 2.5.1 - Validation and Effectiveness

**2.5.1.1** - The methods, responsibility and criteria for ensuring the effectiveness of all applicable elements of the SQF program shall be documented and implemented.

**Response:** Compliant

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##### Summary -

**Response:** SOP 2.5.1 Validation and Effectiveness Rev. 2/11/2026. Reviewed: GMP Validation. Date: -4/16/2026.

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#### 2.5.2 - Verification Activities

**2.5.2.1** - A verification schedule outlining the verification activities, their frequency of completion and the person responsible for each activity shall be prepared and implemented.

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.5.2.2** - Monitoring activities associated with Good Manufacturing Practices (GMP), and other food safety controls, and the legality of certified products, shall be documented and implemented.

**Response:** Compliant

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##### Summary -

**Response:** SOP 2.5.2 Verification Activities Rev. 2/11/2026. Reviewed: Allergen Verification. Date: -4/1/2026.

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#### 2.5.3 - Corrective and Preventative Action

**2.5.3.1** - Corrective action shall be undertaken to resolve non-compliance.

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.5.3.2** - Records of corrective action shall be maintained.

**Response:** Compliant

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##### Summary -

**Response:** SOP 2.5.3 Corrective and Preventative Action Rev. 2/11/2026. Reviewed: CAPA Log. -2025-2026. Reviewed: -CAPA#101289. Reason: -Label error. Date: -12/5/2025. CAPA closed.

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#### 2.5.4 - Product Sampling, Inspection and Analysis

**2.5.4.1** - The methods, responsibility and criteria for sampling, inspecting and/or analyzing raw materials, finished product and work in progress shall be documented and implemented. The methods applied shall ensure: i.

Inspections and analyses are completed at regular intervals as required and to agreed specification and legal requirements; ii. Inspections are conducted to ensure raw materials, work in process and finished products comply with the relevant specification, regulatory requirements and are true to label; and iii. All analyses are conducted to nationally recognized methods or alternative methods which are validated as equivalent to the nationally recognized methods

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.5.4.2** - Where external laboratories are utilized to conduct input or product analysis, the laboratories shall be accredited to ISO 17025 or an equivalent national standard.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 2.5.4 Product Sampling, Inspection, and Analysis Rev. 2/11/2026. The site sampling program consist of testing 1 pound of product per 50 lb container. Reviewed: -Noble Salt test results. Independent Lab. -Certified Labs Inc. Type test: -Coliform. -E. coli. -Salmonella. Date: -3/5/2026. Results acceptable.

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## 2.5.5 - Internal Audits

**2.5.5.1** - The methods and responsibility for scheduling and conducting internal audits to verify the effectiveness of the SQF System shall be documented and implemented. Internal audits shall be conducted at least annually. The methods applied shall ensure: iv. Correction and corrective action of deficiencies identified during the internal audits are undertaken; and v. Records of internal audits and any corrections and corrective action taken as a result of internal audits shall be maintained.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP Internal Audits Rev. 3/19/2026. Yearly Internal Audits cover SQF Modules 2 and 11. Date of last internal audit: -3/19/2026.

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## 2.6.1 - Product Identification

**2.6.1.1** - A product identification system shall be implemented to ensure: i. Product is clearly identified during all stages of receipt, production, storage and dispatch; ii. Finished product is labeled to the customer specification and/or regulatory requirements; and iii. The size of the site and the design of product, types of commodities and/or people flow.

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.6.1.2** - Product Identification records are maintained.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 2.6.1 Product Identification Rev. 2/11/2026. Each raw material is assigned an in-house lot number at receipt. Lot code format: SKU, Supplier Code, 2 Digit Day, Month Letter, and 2 Digit Year.

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## 2.6.2 - Product Trace

**2.6.2.1** - A product trace system shall be implemented to ensure: i. Finished product is traceable to the customer

(one up) and provides traceability through the process to the manufacturing supplier and date of receipt of raw materials, food contact packaging and materials and other inputs (one back); ii. Traceability is maintained where product is reworked; iii. The effectiveness of the product trace system shall be reviewed at least annually; and iv. Records of raw and packaging material receipt and use, and finished product dispatch and destination shall be maintained.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** SOP 2.6.2 Product Trace Rev. 2/11/2026. Reviewed: Mock Trace. Product: -Organic Granulated Garlic. Product Code: -301033. Start Time: -12:18 pm. End Time: 1:00 pm. Percent Recovery. -97.11%. Supporting Documents: -Inventory Analysis Sheet. -Pick Lots Sheets. -Recipe Sheets. -How Used Document. -Receiving Sheet. Date: -3/3/2026.

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### 2.6.3 - Product Withdrawal and Recall

**2.6.3.1** - The site shall outline the methods and responsibility for notifying their customers and other essential bodies where circumstances arise that require product to be withdrawn or recalled from distribution.

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.6.3.2** - SQFI and the certification body shall be notified in writing within 24 hours upon identification of a food safety event that requires public notification. SQFI shall be notified at [foodsafetycrisis@sqfi.com](mailto:foodsafetycrisis@sqfi.com).

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.6.3.3** - Records of all product withdrawals, recalls and mock recalls shall be maintained.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** SOP 2.6.2 Product Trace Rev. 2/11/2026. In accordance with site policy, both SQF and the auditing body are notified within 24 hours if the event requires public notification due to food safety concerns. SOP 2.2.3 Record Control Procedure Rev. 12/8/2025. Records are maintained for 3 years.

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### 2.7.1 - Food Defense Plan

**2.7.1.1** - The methods, responsibility and criteria for preventing food adulteration caused by a deliberate act of sabotage or terrorist-like incident shall be documented, implemented and maintained.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** SOP Food Defense Plan Rev. 2/11/2026. Food Defense requirements apply to raw materials, packaging, WIP, rework, employees, and finished products. The program elements included a Vulnerability Assessment, Controlled Access, Product Storage Controls, Employee Awareness, and Adulteration Prevention Measures. Food Defense Awareness is incorporated into the Annual GMP Training, with the most recent session conducted on 2/11/2026.

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### 2.8.1 - Allergen Management for Food Fundamentals

**2.8.1.1** - The responsibility and methods used to control allergens and to prevent sources of allergens from

contaminating product shall be documented and implemented. The allergen management program shall include:

- i. A risk analysis of those raw materials, ingredients and processing aids, including food grade lubricants, that contain food allergens;
- ii. An assessment of workplace-related food allergens from locker rooms, vending machines, lunch rooms, visitors;
- iii. A register of allergens which is applicable in the country of manufacture and the country(ies) of destination if known;
- iv. A list of allergens which is accessible by relevant staff;
- v. The hazards associated with allergens and their control incorporated into the food safety plan; and
- vi. A management plan for control of identified allergens.

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.8.1.2** - Instructions shall be provided to all relevant staff involved in the receipt or handling of raw materials, work-in progress, rework or finished product on how to identify, handle, store and segregate raw materials containing allergens.

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.8.1.3** - Provision shall be made to clearly identify and segregate foods that contain allergens. Segregation procedures shall be implemented and continually monitored.

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.8.1.4** - Where allergenic material may be intentionally or unintentionally present, cleaning and sanitation of product contact surfaces between line changeovers shall be effective, appropriate to the risk and legal requirements, and sufficient to remove all potential target allergens from product contact surfaces, including aerosols as appropriate, to prevent cross contact. Separate handling and production equipment shall be provided where satisfactory line hygiene and clean-up or segregation is not possible.

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.8.1.5** - Based on risk assessment, procedures for validation and verification of the effectiveness of the cleaning and sanitation of areas and equipment in which allergens are used shall be effectively implemented.

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.8.1.6** - Where allergenic material may be present, product changeover procedures shall be documented and implemented to eliminate the risk of cross-contact.

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.8.1.7** - The product identification system shall make provision for clear identification and labeling in accordance with regulatory requirements of those products produced on production lines and equipment on which foods containing allergens were manufactured.

**Response:** Compliant

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**2.8.1.8** - The site shall document and implement methods to control the accuracy of finished product labels (or consumer information where applicable) and assure work in progress and finished product is true to label with regard to allergens. Such measures may include label approvals at receipt, label reconciliations during production, destruction of obsolete labels and verification of labels on finished product as appropriate and product change over procedures.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 2.8.1 Allergen Management of Food Fundamentals Rev. 3/16/2026. The site manages five

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allergens—Peanuts, Tree Nuts, Sesame, Soy, and Milk—and verifies controls through routine pre-operational allergen swabbing. Swabs are performed on food-contact and high-risk surfaces as part of the site's allergen management and sanitation verification programs. The facility uses the Neogen Reveal 3D system to detect allergen residues. Swab results are reviewed prior to start-up to confirm that cleaning procedures have effectively removed allergenic material and that equipment and surfaces are safe for production. A review of allergen swab records for the Blend Room Table (4/11/2026) showed acceptable results, supporting both pre-op release and verification of cleaning effectiveness. These results demonstrate effective control of allergen cross-contact risks. Allergens in the warehouse are clearly labeled, stored in designated areas, and fully segregated. Allergen-storage zones are color-coded to support quick visual identification and prevent cross-contact.

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### 2.9.1 - Training Requirements

**2.9.1.1** - Appropriate training shall be provided for personnel carrying out the tasks essential to the effective implementation of the SQF System and the maintenance of food safety and regulatory requirements.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** SOP 2.9.1 Training Rev. 2/3/2026. Training is managed and delivered by the SQF Practitioner. Instruction is provided in a classroom setting using PowerPoint presentations. A verbal quiz is conducted during each training block to verify employee understanding.

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### 2.9.2 - Training Program

**2.9.2.1** - An employee training program shall be documented and implemented. It shall outline the necessary skills for specific duties and the training methods to be applied for those staff carrying out tasks associated with: i. Developing and applying Good Manufacturing Practices; and ii. Applying food regulatory requirements.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** yes

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### 2.9.3 - Instructions

**2.9.3.1** - Instructions shall be available in the languages relevant to the staff, explaining how all tasks critical to meeting regulatory compliance, the maintenance of food safety and process efficiency are to be performed.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** SOP 2.9.3 Instructions Rev. 2/7/2026. Instructions for all procedure and SOPs are written in English, which is the relevant and fully understood language for all employees at the facility. This ensures that personnel can correctly follow the required steps and maintain compliance with established food safety and quality procedures.

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### 2.9.4 - HACCP Training Requirements

**2.9.4.1** - The person(s) involved in developing and maintaining food safety plans shall be trained in the HACCP method.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP HACCP Training Requirements Rev. 2/7/2026. The SQF Practitioner and the designated alternate are both HACCP trained, with their most recent HACCP training completed on 10/3/2025. Verified training records confirming successful completion are maintained on file and were reviewed as part of this assessment.

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## 2.9.5 - Language

**2.9.5.1** - Training materials and the delivery of training shall be provided in language understood by staff.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** All training is delivered in English, which is the common language understood by all employees at the facility. This ensures consistent comprehension of food safety, quality, and regulatory requirements across all departments.

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## 2.9.6 - Refresher Training

**2.9.6.1** - The training program shall include provision for identifying and implementing the refresher training needs of the organization.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 2.9.6 Refresher Training Rev. 2/7/2026. Refresher training is conducted annually and is jointly managed by the SQF Practitioner (SQFP) and the Quality Unit. The site maintains a training matrix that outlines all required topics included in the Master File. Annual training covers cGMP, Food Safety, Food Defense, and Allergens, ensuring all personnel remain competent in core food safety and regulatory requirements.

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## 2.9.7 - Training Skills Register

**2.9.7.1** - A training skills register describing who has been trained in relevant skills shall be maintained.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** The site maintains a training log that documents the topics covered, the date of training, and the employees who participated. This file is maintained and controlled by the SQF Practitioner (SQFP) to ensure accuracy, completeness, and traceability.

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## 11.1.1 - Premises Location and Approval

**11.1.1.1** - The location of the premises shall be such that adjacent and adjoining buildings, operations and land use do not interfere with safe and hygienic operations.



**Response:** Compliant

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**11.1.1.2** - The construction and ongoing operation of the premises on the site shall be approved by the relevant authority.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** The location of the premises is such that adjacent and adjoining buildings, operations, and land use do not interfere with safe or hygienic operations. The site holds a valid Certificate of Occupancy issued by Point Township, Certificate #24400034, with an issuance date of October 26, 2024.

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### 11.2.1 - Materials and Surfaces

**11.2.1.1** - Product contact surfaces and those surfaces not in direct contact with food in food handling areas, raw material storage, packaging material storage, and cold storage areas shall be constructed of materials that will not contribute a food safety risk.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** All food-contact and non-food-contact surfaces within the facility are constructed of smooth, durable, non-porous, and easily cleanable materials, consistent with SQF requirements for hygienic design. These surfaces support effective cleaning and sanitation, minimize the risk of product contamination, and comply with the facility's validated sanitation procedures.

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### 11.2.2 - Floors, Drains and Waste Traps

**11.2.2.1** - Floors shall be constructed of smooth, dense impact resistant material that can be effectively graded, drained, impervious to liquid and easily cleaned.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.2.2** - Drains and waste trap systems shall be constructed and located so they can be easily cleaned and not present a hazard.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** The facility floors are constructed of smooth, durable concrete and were observed to be in good condition, free of cracks, pits, or damage that could impede cleaning. The site does not have active floor drains, consistent with its dry production environment, and therefore does not utilize waste traps. Housekeeping and sanitation practices are designed to ensure effective dry cleaning and removal of debris in the absence of drainage infrastructure.

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### 11.2.3 - Walls, Partitions, Doors and Ceilings

**11.2.3.1** - Walls, partitions, ceilings and doors shall be of durable construction. Internal surfaces shall be smooth and impervious with a light-colored finish, and shall be kept clean (refer to 11.2.13.1).

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** Walls, floors, and ceilings were observed to be in good repair and constructed to allow proper cleaning and effective maintenance. The walls are light in color, supporting visibility during cleaning and inspection and aligning with SQF expectations for hygienic design and facility condition monitoring.

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#### 11.2.4 - Stairs, Catwalks and Platforms

**11.2.4.1** - Stairs, catwalks and platforms in food processing and handling areas shall be designed and constructed so as not to present a product contamination risk, and with no open grates directly above exposed food product surfaces. They shall be kept clean (refer to 11.2.13.1).

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not have stairs, catwalks or platforms.

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#### Summary -

**Response:** The site does not have stairs, catwalks or platforms.

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#### 11.2.5 - Lightings and Light Fittings

**11.2.5.1** - Lighting in food processing and handling areas and at inspection stations shall be of appropriate intensity to enable the staff to carry out their tasks efficiently and effectively.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.5.2** - Light fittings in processing areas, inspection stations, ingredient and packaging storage areas, and all areas where the product is exposed shall be shatterproof, manufactured with a shatterproof covering or fitted with protective covers and recessed into or fitted flush with the ceiling. Where fittings cannot be recessed, structures must be protected from accidental breakage, manufactured from cleanable materials and addressed in the cleaning and sanitation program.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.5.3** - Light fittings in warehouses and other areas where the product is protected shall be designed such as to prevent breakage and product contamination.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** Illumination throughout the facility was observed to be adequate, providing sufficient visibility for employees to perform tasks safely and effectively. All light fixtures were operational at the time of inspection. Overhead lighting is equipped with shatterproof or properly shielded fixtures.

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#### 11.2.6 - Inspection/Quality Control Area

**11.2.6.1** - A suitable area shall be provided for the inspection of the product if required.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** Product is inspected as part of the customer order fulfillment process, with checks performed to verify condition, accuracy, and compliance with customer specification requirements. The designated

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inspection areas were observed to be clean, orderly, and adequately illuminated.

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### 11.2.7 - Dust, Insect and Pest Proofing

**11.2.7.1** - All external windows, ventilation openings, doors and other openings shall be effectively sealed when closed and proofed against dust, vermin and other pests.

**Response:** Minor

**Evidence:** • The warehouse perimeter had openings and gaps that were not fully sealed, creating potential entry points and harborage conditions for insects and other pests. This condition indicates a need for improved structural sealing

**Root Cause:** Root Cause Analysis The root cause identified for this non-conformance is: • Immediate cause: Concrete expansion and control joints along the warehouse perimeter floor — including joints at the wall base and around structural column base plates — are open and unsealed. These joints are a standard feature of the building's concrete slab construction, designed to accommodate thermal expansion and structural movement. • Root cause: When the facility was established in the current building, the open expansion joints were not identified as a food safety pest-exclusion risk requiring remediation. No formal pest-proofing inspection procedure existed that specifically evaluated structural floor joints and column surrounds as potential pest entry points and harborage sites. As a result, no action was taken to seal the joints as part of the facility build-out or subsequent maintenance, and the condition was not flagged through any internal inspection or audit process prior to the SQF audit. • Contributing factor: The facility lacked a documented annual perimeter inspection protocol with a defined checklist that would have identified the open joints as a gap requiring correction. The condition was present throughout the facility's occupancy of the building but was not formally recognized as a compliance risk until the SQF auditor's observation on April 17, 2026.

**Corrective Action:** Conduct full perimeter walk to map all open expansion/control joints along warehouse wall base and around steel column base plates. Document locations with photographs before any sealing work begins. Engage DePoe Construction to fill and seal all identified expansion and control joints using food-facility-appropriate flexible joint sealant (polyurethane or epoxy-based, rated for heavy floor traffic and pest exclusion). Compile pre- and post-repair photograph set (matched angles) for all sealed joint locations. Upload to Eagle CMX1 as objective evidence with corrective action response.

**Verification Of Closeout:** 1. Pre-repair photographic documentation of five open expansion joint and column base plate locations along the warehouse back wall, taken April 24, 2026 to establish a baseline record prior to sealing work by the building facilities contractor. 2. The CAR documenting the SQF audit finding of unsealed warehouse perimeter expansion joints, including root cause analysis, corrective action plan (CA-1 sealing, CA-2 photo documentation), systemic preventive actions, and an Objective Evidence table tracking seven supporting documents through completion. 3. Signed agreement with DePoe Construction (Chris DePoe, PA HICPA #PA181636) for twice-annual inspection and resealing of expansion joints and column base plate surrounds at 315 Point Township Drive, executed April 24, 2026 4. Formal SOP addendum establishing the annual structural pest-proofing inspection program, defining roles for the building facilities contractor (inspection and repair) and pest control contractor (harborage monitoring), with a 1/4-inch corrective action trigger and 30-day sealing requirement. 5. Standardized Excel workbook used to document each annual perimeter inspection, with pre-populated inspection points across expansion joints, floor-wall junctions, and column base plate surrounds, plus a corrective action log and dual signature block.

**Completion Date:** May 8, 2026

**Closeout Date:** May 1, 2026

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**11.2.7.2** - External personnel access doors shall be provided. They shall be effectively insect-proofed and fitted with

a self-closing device and proper seals to protect against ingress of dust, vermin and other pests.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.7.3** - External doors, including overhead dock doors in food handling areas used for product, pedestrian or truck access shall be insect-proofed by at least one or a combination of the following methods: i. A self-closing device; ii. An effective air curtain; iii. An insect-proof screen; iv. An insect-proof annex; and v. Adequate sealing around trucks in docking areas.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.7.4** - Electric insect control devices, pheromone or other traps and baits shall be located so as not to present a contamination risk to the product, packaging, containers or processing equipment. Poison rodenticide bait shall not be used inside ingredient or product storage areas or processing areas.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** Personnel access points are equipped with functional, well-maintained self-closing devices, and no doors were observed standing open when unattended. All man-doors were confirmed to be self-closing and in good repair, supporting controlled access and preventing pest entry. Insect light traps (ILTs) are properly installed away from product and food-contact areas. Pest control monitoring devices were strategically placed along the interior perimeter of the facility to provide effective surveillance without posing a contamination risk. The facility does not store pesticides onsite. Minor: 11.2.7.1 The warehouse perimeter had openings and gaps that were not fully sealed, creating potential entry points and harborage conditions for insects and other pests. This condition indicates a need for improved structural sealing.

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## 11.2.8 - Ventilation

**11.2.8.1** - Adequate ventilation shall be provided in enclosed processing and food handling areas.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.8.2** - All ventilation equipment and devices in product storage and handling areas shall be adequately cleaned as per 11.2.12, to prevent unsanitary conditions.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.8.3** - Extractor fans and canopies shall be provided in areas where cooking operations are carried out or a large amount of steam is generated and shall have the following features: i. Capture velocities shall be sufficient to prevent condensation build up and to evacuate all heat, fumes and other aerosols to the exterior via an exhaust hood positioned over the cooker(s); ii. Fans and exhaust vents shall be insect-proofed and located so as not to pose a contamination risk; and iii. Where appropriate, positive air-pressure system shall be installed to prevent airborne contamination.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** The site's HVAC system was observed to be operating properly in both the production area and the warehouse, maintaining appropriate environmental conditions for the facility's dry-processing operations. The HVAC system was last serviced by Eco Air Mechanical Service on 5/15/2025, with service records maintained on file. The facility does not utilize extraction fans or canopies.

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### 11.2.9 - Equipment, Utensils and Protective Clothing

**11.2.9.1** - Equipment and utensils shall be designed, constructed, installed, operated and maintained to meet any applicable regulatory requirements and not to pose a contamination threat to products.

**Response:** Compliant

**11.2.9.2** - Benches, tables, conveyors, mixers, mincers, graders and other mechanical processing equipment shall be hygienically designed and located for appropriate cleaning. Equipment surfaces shall be smooth, impervious and free from cracks or crevices.

**Response:** Compliant

#### Summary -

**Response:** Equipment and utensils used at the site are constructed of stainless steel or other durable, non-porous, food-grade materials appropriate for hygienic use. Site utensils—including scoops, bowls, and sifters—are stainless steel, and funnels are made of food-grade, non-porous plastic suitable for product contact. Production equipment, such as blenders, is also constructed of stainless steel and designed for effective cleaning. All equipment and utensils were observed to be clean, well-maintained, and in good repair. Aprons are provided by the company and are maintained in a clean, serviceable condition to support personnel hygiene requirements.

### 11.2.10 - Premises and Equipment Maintenance

**11.2.10.1** - The methods and responsibility for the maintenance and repair of plant, equipment and buildings shall be documented, planned and implemented in a manner that minimizes the risk of product, packaging or equipment contamination.

**Response:** Compliant

**11.2.10.2** - Routine maintenance of plant and equipment in any food processing, handling or storage area shall be performed according to a maintenance-control schedule and recorded. The maintenance schedule shall be prepared to cover building, equipment and other areas of the premises critical to the maintenance of product safety and quality.

**Response:** Compliant

**11.2.10.3** - Failures of plant and equipment in any food processing, handling or storage area shall be documented, reviewed and their repair incorporated into the maintenance control schedule.

**Response:** Compliant

**11.2.10.4** - Maintenance staff and contractors shall comply with the site's personnel and process hygiene requirements (refer to 11.3.1, 11.3.2, 11.3.3, 11.3.4).

**Response:** Compliant

**11.2.10.5** - All maintenance and other engineering contractors required to work on site shall be trained in the site's food safety and hygiene procedures, or shall be escorted at all times, until their work is completed.

**Response:** Compliant

**11.2.10.6** - The maintenance supervisor and the site supervisor shall be informed if any repairs or maintenance pose a potential threat to product safety (i.e. pieces of electrical wire, damaged light fittings, and loose overhead fittings). When possible, maintenance is to be conducted outside processing times.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.10.7** - Temporary repairs, where required shall not pose a food safety risk and shall be included in the cleaning program. There shall be a plan in place to address completion of temporary repairs to ensure they do not become permanent solutions.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.10.8** - Maintenance staff and contractors shall remove all tools and debris from any maintenance activity once it has been completed and inform the area supervisor and maintenance supervisor so appropriate hygiene and sanitation can be completed and a pre-operational inspection conducted prior to the commencement of site operations.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.10.9** - Equipment located over product or product conveyors shall be lubricated with food grade lubricants and their use controlled to minimize the contamination of the product.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.10.10** - Paint used in a food handling or contact zone shall be suitable for use and in good condition and shall not be used on any product contact surface.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### **Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 11.2.1.1 Procedure for Maintenance and Repair of Equipment and or Facility Rev. 3/16/2026 governs the site's maintenance program. The COO oversees the repairs and preventive maintenance program, including management of the maintenance log, which houses all preventive maintenance (PM) records and work orders. During the facility inspection, no temporary repairs, damaged surfaces, or chipped paint were observed. Reviewed: -Rotary Blender PM. Date: -2/20/2026. Label Printer PM. Date: -3/2/2026.

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### **11.2.11 - Calibration**

**11.2.11.1** - The methods and responsibility for the calibration and re-calibration of measuring, test and inspection equipment used for monitoring activities critical to food safety and regulatory requirements shall be documented and implemented.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.11.2** - Procedures shall be documented and implemented to address the disposition of potentially affected products should measuring, test and inspection equipment be found to be out of calibration state.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.11.3** - Calibrated measuring, test and inspected equipment shall be protected from damage and unauthorized adjustment.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.11.4** - Equipment shall be calibrated against national or international reference standards and methods or to accuracy appropriate to its use. In cases where standards are not available, the site shall provide evidence to support the calibration reference method applied.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.11.5** - Calibration shall be performed according to regulatory requirements and/or to the equipment manufacturers recommended schedule.

**Response:** Minor

**Evidence:** • The scale at Station #7 was not calibrated as required; the calibration due date was March 2026, and the unit is currently past due.

**Root Cause:** Root Cause Analysis The root cause identified for this non-conformance is: • Immediate cause: Annual calibration was not scheduled or completed before the March 2026 due date for multiple production scales. • Root cause: The calibration program lacked a formal preventive maintenance schedule with assigned ownership, advance notification triggers, and documented accountability. Calibration was treated as a reactive task — noticed and scheduled only after the due date passed — rather than a proactive maintenance item tracked on a documented schedule with a defined responsible person.

**Corrective Action:** Schedule and complete annual calibration of all production scales (25 lb. and 150 lb. units) through licensed calibration service. Obtain a calibration certificate for each unit. Add all measuring instruments (scales, thermometers) to Maintenance Log with: asset number, calibration frequency, last calibration date, and next due date. Obtain Senior Management approval (Core 4) to purchase certified calibration weights for internal scale verification. Place order upon approval.

**Verification Of Closeout:** 1. Standard Operating Procedure for internal quarterly scale calibration using the NIST-traceable Rice Lake weight set, covering responsibilities, acceptance criteria by scale capacity, step-by-step procedure, out-of-tolerance response, and recordkeeping requirements; approved by Glenna DePoe 04/30/2026. 2. Internal scale inventory listing all 19 production scales by item type, manufacturer, model, serial number, capacity, and inspection dates; documents the 04/23/2026 calibration event with next inspection due 04/23/2027, and flags Blending Room Small Scale 2 (F24-008616) with a same-day re-inspect notation. 3. Commonwealth of Pennsylvania Department of Agriculture official inspection record (Inspection ID 86950, 04/23/2026, Inspector Austin Long) documenting routine calibration of 18 scales at Spices, Inc.; 17 passed, 1 failed (Blending Room Small Scale 2, Serial F24-008616, out of tolerance). 4. Corrective Action Report for the SQF audit finding that multiple production scales were past their annual calibration due date; documents root cause, three corrective actions (CA-1–CA-3), three preventive actions (PA-1–PA-3), objective evidence, and SQF Practitioner sign-off. 5. Internal Senior Management approval memorandum dated 04/17/2026 documenting Core 4's authorization for Glenna DePoe to purchase NIST-traceable calibration weights (est. \$600–\$650, vendor ULINE or Scales Plus) as required by NC-2 Corrective Action CA-3. 6. Facility-wide preventive maintenance schedule tracking all equipment by location, task, frequency, last completed date, next due date, and responsible department; updated to reflect annual scale calibration completed 04/23/2026 with next due 04/23/2027. 7. Purchase order confirmation dated 04/30/2026 for three NIST-traceable Rice Lake calibration weights (50 lb. ASTM Class 6, 5 lb. ASTM Class 7, 1 lb. ASTM Class 5) ordered by Kylie Rankin, totaling \$613.48 including shipping and PA tax.

**Completion Date:** April 30, 2026

**Closeout Date:** May 1, 2026

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**11.2.11.6** - Calibration records shall be maintained.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 11.2.3.1 Procedure for Calibrating Measuring of Equipment Rev. 3/16/2026. Minor: 11.2.11.5 The scale at Station #7 was not calibrated as required; the calibration due date was March 2026, and the unit is currently past due.

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**11.2.12.1** - The methods and responsibility for pest prevention shall be documented and effectively implemented. The premises, its surrounding areas, storage facilities, machinery and equipment shall be kept free of waste or accumulated debris so as not to attract pests and vermin.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.12.2** - Identified pest activity shall not present a risk of contamination to food products, raw materials or packaging.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.12.3** - The pest prevention program shall: i. A record of pest sightings; ii. The methods used to prevent pest problems; iii. The pest elimination methods (e.g. rodent glue boards, bait stations and insect electrocutors); iv. The frequency with which pest status is to be checked; v. A site map the identification, location, number and type of bait stations set; vi. The chemicals used (they are required to be approved by the relevant authority and their Safety Data Sheets (SDS) made available); vii. The methods used to make staff aware of the bait control program and the measures to take when they come into contact with a bait station; and viii. The requirements for staff awareness and training in the use of pest and vermin control chemicals and baits.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.12.4** - Inspections for pest activity shall be undertaken on a regular basis by trained personnel and the appropriate action taken if pests are present.

**Response:** Minor

**Evidence:** • The pest control operator license was not available on file for review at the time of the assessment.

**Root Cause:** Root Cause Analysis The root cause identified for this non-conformance is: • Immediate cause: The current Ehrlich applicator's license was not placed in the facility's pest control binder following the transition from the previous pest control provider (Orkin) to Ehrlich. • Root cause: The facility did not have a documented contractor onboarding procedure for pest control providers establishing a defined checklist of required documentation to be collected at or before the first service visit. Responsibility for verifying that documentation was complete and current was not formally assigned to a specific person, and no calendar reminder or verification schedule existed to confirm documentation currency on an ongoing basis. • Contributing factor: The facility had used the previous provider (Orkin) for multiple years without documentation currency issues. The transition to Ehrlich exposed a gap in contractor documentation management that had not previously required active management under the long-term provider relationship.

**Corrective Action:** Contact Ehrlich to obtain physical copy of current technician's valid Pennsylvania pesticide applicator license. Remove expired prior-technician license from pest control binder; insert current license. Retain both for transition record. Request updated certificate of insurance from Ehrlich naming Spices, Inc. (315 Point Township Drive, Northumberland, PA 17857) as certificate holder. File in pest control documentation binder.

**Verification Of Closeout:** 1. A printed email exchange dated April 24, 2026 in which Glenna DePoe formally notified Ehrlich of the facility's three standing documentation requirements, and Ehrlich's Operations Manager Daryl R. Miller Jr. confirmed in writing that they fully understand and will comply. 2. A simple log used at each Ehrlich service visit to record the technician's name, confirm license verification, note the service type, and capture the verifying employee's initials before work begins. 3. The completed one-page onboarding checklist (PCO-OBC-001) used to verify that a new pest control provider has submitted all three required documents — PA applicator license, certificate of insurance, and SDS sheets — before beginning service. 4. The three-page corrective action report documenting the finding that Ehrlich's current technician license was not on file at the time of the April 17 SQF audit, including root cause analysis, the CA/PA action plan, and the completed objective



evidence table showing all five items closed. 5. The three-page corrective action report documenting the finding that Ehrlich's current technician license was not on file at the time of the April 17 SQF audit, including root cause analysis, the CA/PA action plan, and the completed objective evidence table showing all five items closed. 6. Seven current PA pesticide applicator licenses for Ehrlich technicians (all issued 01/06/2026, expiring 02/28/2027) plus an ACORD Certificate of Liability Insurance dated 4/19/2026 naming Spices, Inc. at 315 Point Township Drive as certificate holder, with coverage through 10/1/2026.

**Completion Date:** April 27, 2026

**Closeout Date:** May 1, 2026

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#### Summary -

**Response:** SOP Pest Prevention Program Rev. 3/16/2026. The site uses a contracted pest control service (Ehrlich). Their frequency is monthly. Site schematic showed all pest control monitoring devices. SDS were available and accurate. Reviewed: -Service Report. Date: -4/7/2026. Minor: 11.2.12.4 The pest control operator license was not available on file for review at the time of the assessment.

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### 11.2.13 - Cleaning and Sanitation

**11.2.13.1** - The methods and responsibility for the cleaning of the food handling and processing equipment and environment, storage areas, staff amenities and toilet facilities shall be documented and implemented. Consideration shall be given to: i. What is to be cleaned; ii. How it is to be cleaned; iii. When it is to be cleaned; iv. Who is responsible for the cleaning; v. Methods used to confirm the correct concentrations of detergents and sanitizers, and vi. The responsibility and methods used to verify the effectiveness of the cleaning and sanitation program.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.13.2** - Provision shall be made for the effective cleaning of processing equipment, utensils and protective clothing.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.2.13.3** - Suitably equipped areas shall be designated for cleaning product containers, knives, cutting boards and other utensils and for cleaning of protective clothing used by staff. These cleaning operations shall be controlled so as not to interfere with manufacturing operations, equipment or product. Racks and containers for storing cleaned utensils shall be provided as required.

**Response:** Minor

**Evidence:** • The utensil racks in the washrooms were not labeled or otherwise designated, making it impossible to distinguish clean utensils from dirty ones. This creates a risk of cross contamination and breaks the traceability of the wash-rinse-sanitize process.

**Root Cause:** Root Cause Analysis The root cause identified for this non-conformance is: • Immediate cause: Utensil racks in the dish room had no permanent labels or markings designating clean versus soiled storage zones. • Root cause: The dish room sanitation SOP and the daily Pre-Op checklist defined the wash-rinse-sanitize process steps but did not include an explicit requirement that permanent, fixed labeling be present on the racks themselves to designate clean and dirty zones independently of mobile cart labels. Because no internal SOP requirement or inspection checklist criteria called for rack-level designation, this physical control was never established and was not identified as a gap during internal review. • Contributing factor: The team associated the clean/dirty status of utensils with the cart labels already in use for transporting utensils between the production floor and dish room, creating an implicit assumption that the visual distinction was covered — when in fact the racks themselves had no designation.

**Corrective Action:** Install permanent, waterproof labels on dish room utensil racks: clean rack labeled 'CLEAN'; soiled staging area labeled 'DIRTY' Material must be cleanable and waterproof (laminated or equivalent). Take and retain photographs as evidence.

**Verification Of Closeout:** 1. Corrective action report for the SQF audit finding that utensil racks lacked permanent clean/dirty designation, including root cause analysis, the corrective action plan, systemic preventive actions, and objective evidence demonstrating full remediation across SOPs, checklists, training, and photographic records. 2. Corrective action record documenting the dish room clean/dirty zone rack labeling finding from the April 17, 2026 audit, with photograph documentation of installed CLEAN and DIRTY labels as objective evidence of compliance. 3. Pre-Op inspection checklist completed daily by Derek and verified by Glenna, covering production sanitation, dish room, physical/chemical/allergen hazards, and forklift condition. Includes the newly added line item for clean and dirty rack label verification. 4. Standard Operating Procedure governing all dish room operations, including allergen and non-allergen utensil washing, bowl rotation, glove color-coding, and clean/dirty zone control. Updated 04/24/2026 to add explicit rack labeling requirements, daily Pre-Op label verification, and a corrective action response procedure for label failures found during Pre-Op. 5. Documents Spices, Inc.'s employee training program structure, covering required skills, training methods, and topics, including GMPs, food safety requirements, and dish room clean/dirty zone designation as a cross-contamination prevention control. Updated to reflect SQF 11.2.13.S1 rack labeling requirements as a named training topic.

**Completion Date:** April 30, 2026

**Closeout Date:** April 30, 2026

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**11.2.13.4** - Pre-operational inspections shall be conducted following cleaning and sanitation operations to ensure food processing areas, product contact surfaces, equipment, staff amenities and sanitary facilities and other essential areas are clean before the commencement of production. Pre-operational inspections shall be conducted by qualified personnel.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** SOP 11.2.5.1 Procedure for Cleaning and Sanitation Rev. 3/16/2026 outlines the site's sanitation requirements, responsibilities, and verification activities. The facility maintains a Master Cleaning Schedule (MCS) that includes daily checklists for the production area, warehouse, and common areas. Daily cleaning records for March were reviewed and found to be complete and properly verified. Pre-operational checks, conducted by area managers, include sanitation verification to ensure equipment and areas are clean and ready prior to start-up. Minor 11.2.13.3 The utensil racks in the washrooms were not labeled or otherwise designated, making it impossible to distinguish clean utensils from dirty ones. This creates a risk of cross contamination and breaks the traceability of the wash-rinse-sanitize process.

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### 11.3.1 - Personnel

**11.3.1.1** - Personnel who are known to have been known to be carriers, or are carriers, of infectious diseases that present a health risk to others through the packing or storage processes shall not engage in the processing or packing of food, or enter storage areas where food is exposed.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.3.1.2** - The site shall have measures in place to prevent contact of materials, ingredients, food packaging, food, or food contact surfaces from any bodily fluids from open wounds, coughing, sneezing, spitting, or any other means.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.3.1.3** - Personnel with exposed cuts, sores or lesions shall not be engaged in handling or processing products or handling primary packaging materials or food contact surfaces. Minor cuts or abrasions on exposed parts of the body shall be covered with a colored bandage containing a metal strip or an alternative suitable waterproof and colored dressing.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.3.1.4** - Smoking, chewing, eating, or spitting is not permitted in areas where product is produced, stored, or otherwise exposed. Drinking of water is permissible only under conditions that prevent contamination or other food safety risks from occurring. Drinking water containers in production and storage areas shall be stored in clear, covered containers, and in designated areas away from raw materials, packaging or equipment.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** SOP 11.3.1 Personnel Hygiene and Welfare Rev. 2/7/2026. The procedures include practices for handling bodily fluid spills and medical screening. No employees or visitors were observed with visible signs of infectious diseases or with cuts or lesions.

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### 11.3.2 - Handwashing

**11.3.2.1** - Hand wash basins shall be provided adjacent to all personnel access points and in accessible locations throughout food handling and processing areas as required.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.3.2.2** - Hand wash basins shall be constructed of stainless steel or similar non-corrosive material and as a minimum supplied with: i. A potable water supply at an appropriate temperature; ii. Liquid soap contained within a fixed dispenser; iii. Paper towels in a hands free cleanable dispenser; and iv. A means of containing used paper towels.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.3.2.3** - The following additional facilities shall be provided in high risk areas: i. Hands free operated taps; and ii. Hand sanitizers.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.3.2.4** - A sign instructing people to wash their hands, and in appropriate languages, shall be provided in a prominent position.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** SOP 11.3.1 Personnel Hygiene and Welfare Rev. 2/7/2026. A stainless steel handwash basin is strategically installed at the entrance points leading into the facility and is fully equipped with warm running water, liquid soap, single-use paper towels, trash receptacles, and clearly posted handwashing signage. During the audit, employees consistently demonstrated proper handwashing practices, and appropriate glove use was observed in all food-contact areas. Mandatory handwash signs were also clearly posted in all restrooms.

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### 11.3.3 - Clothing

**11.3.3.1** - The site shall ensure that the clothing and hair policy protects materials, food and food contact surfaces from unintentional microbiological or physical contamination.

**Response:** Minor

**Evidence:** • An employee in the production area was observed wearing a baseball cap with a hairnet underneath, which does not comply with the site's hair restraint policy requiring the hairnet to be the outermost layer.

**Root Cause:** Root Cause Analysis The root cause identified for this non-conformance is: • Immediate cause: One employee wore a baseball cap over their hairnet rather than under it while working on the production floor. • Root cause: The GMP training program covered hair restraint requirements as a policy statement but did not include a hands-on demonstration or visual reference showing correct versus incorrect configurations for different headwear types (hairnet only; beanie under hairnet; cap under hairnet). Without a point-of-use visual aid at the gowning station and an explicit inspection criterion on the daily Pre-Op checklist, the employee's practical understanding of the requirement for non-beanie headwear was not verified prior to this observation. • Contributing factor: The employee had previously worn beanies during colder months, which naturally sit underneath the hairnet. When transitioning to a baseball cap as temperatures warmed, the employee was not reminded of the difference in correct positioning, and the daily Pre-Op inspection did not catch the error before the audit.

**Corrective Action:** Immediate Corrective CA-1 Employee was corrected immediately on the production floor during the audit. Employee was verbally re-instructed on the correct procedure (hairnet must be the outermost layer) and complied for the remainder of the shift. Immediate Corrective CA-2 Conduct targeted hair restraint re-training with ALL production floor employees. Include: (a) verbal review of policy (hairnet must be outermost layer, covering hat crown AND brim); (b) hands-on demonstration of correct vs. incorrect configurations; (c) note that a larger hairnet is required when wearing a baseball cap vs. a beanie. Collect signed attendance log. Preventive / Systemic PA-2 Update daily Pre-Op Checklist to add line item: 'Jewelry / Hairnet / GMP — hairnet is outermost layer for all employees.' Preventive / Systemic PA-3 Update 2.4.2 GMP to reflect correct hair restraint usage, hands-on demonstration to be included as part of new employee onboarding and annual GMP refresher training.

**Verification Of Closeout:** 1. Training reference document outlining the correct layering order, scenario-specific requirements, beard net coverage standards, and gowning self-check procedure used during the all-staff hair restraint demonstration on 04/23/2026. 2. Corrective Action Report for the hair restraint non-conformance identified during the SQF certification audit, documenting root cause analysis, corrective and preventive actions, and objective evidence requirements with a verification due date of 05/16/2026. 3. Signed attendance log documenting 100% production floor employee participation in the targeted hair restraint re-training demonstration conducted by Glenna DePoe on 04/23/2026, serving as objective evidence for CA-2 of NC-3. 4. Signed attendance log documenting 100% production floor employee participation in the targeted hair restraint re-training demonstration conducted by Glenna DePoe on 04/23/2026, serving as objective evidence for CA-2 of NC-3. 5. Documents Spices, Inc.'s employee training program requirements, including role-specific training delivery, GMP and HACCP training obligations, refresher training triggers, and the training skills register maintained by the SQF Project Manager. Updated 04/27/2026 to explicitly require hands-on demonstration of proper hair restraint application and usage as a component of GMP training, and to incorporate hair restraint demonstration into the annual GMP refresher as a standing requirement. 6. Establishes site-wide GMP requirements for all personnel, including hair restraint configuration, handwashing, personal protective equipment, and facility and equipment cleanliness standards. Approved 04/27/2026.

**Completion Date:** April 27, 2026

**Closeout Date:** April 30, 2026

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**11.3.3.2** - Clothing worn by staff engaged in handling food shall be maintained, stored, laundered and worn so as

not to present a contamination risk to products.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.3.3.3** - Clothing including shoes, shall be clean at the commencement of each shift and maintained in a serviceable condition.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.3.3.4** - Excessively soiled uniforms shall be changed or replaced where they present a product contamination risk.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.3.3.5** - Disposable gloves and aprons shall be changed after each break, upon re-entry into the processing area and when damaged. Non-disposable aprons and gloves shall be cleaned and sanitized as required and when not in use stored on racks provided in the processing area or designated sealed containers in personnel lockers and not on packaging, ingredients, product or equipment.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 11.3.1 Personnel Hygiene and Welfare Rev. 2/7/2026. Minor: 11.3.3.1 3. An employee in the production area was observed wearing a baseball cap with a hairnet underneath, which does not comply with the site's hair restraint policy requiring the hairnet to be the outermost layer.

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#### 11.3.4 - Jewelry and Personal Effects

**11.3.4.1** - Jewelry and other loose objects shall not be worn or taken into a food handling or processing operation or any area where food is exposed. The wearing of plain bands with no stones and prescribed medical alert bracelets can be permitted, however the site will need to consider their customer requirements and the applicable food legislation.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 11.3.1 Personnel Hygiene and Welfare Rev. 2/7/2026. No jewelry or loose objects were observed on personnel during the plant inspection, demonstrating compliance with the site's personal hygiene and foreign material prevention.

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#### 11.3.5 - Visitors

**11.3.5.1** - All visitors, including management and maintenance staff, shall wear suitable clothing and footwear when entering any food processing or handling area.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.3.5.2** - All visitors shall be required to remove jewelry and other loose objects.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.3.5.3** - Visitors exhibiting visible signs of illness shall be prevented from entering areas in which food is handled or processed.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.3.5.4** - Visitors shall enter and exit food handling areas through the proper staff entrance points and comply with all hand washing and personnel practice requirements.

**Response:** Compliant

**11.3.5.5** - All visitors shall be trained in the site's food safety and hygiene procedures before entering any food processing or handling areas, or shall be escorted at all times in food processing, handling and storage areas.

**Response:** Compliant

**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 11.3.5 Visitors Rev. 0. Visitors and contractors are required to read the site GMP Policy and sign in at the front desk upon arrival. After sign-in, the receptionist notifies the designated site sponsor, who must come to the lobby to pick up the visitor. All visitors and contractors must remain under escort by their sponsor for the full duration of their time onsite.

### 11.3.6 - Staff Amenities

**11.3.6** - Not applicable for SQF Fundamentals for Manufacturing - Intermediate

**Response:** N/A

### 11.3.7 - Change Rooms

**11.3.7.1** - Change room facilities shall be provided to enable staff and visitors to change into and out of protective clothing as required.

**Response:** Compliant

**Summary -**

**Response:** Separate change rooms are provided for employees, offering designated space for changing into and out of work attire (aprons) in a hygienic and organized manner.

### 11.3.8 - Laundry

**11.3.8** - Not applicable for SQF Fundamentals for Manufacturing - Intermediate

**Response:** N/A

### 11.3.9 - Sanitary Facilities

**11.3.9.1** - Toilet rooms shall be: i. Designed and constructed so that they are accessible to staff and separate from any processing and food handling operations; ii. Accessed from the processing area via an airlock vented to the exterior or through an adjoining room; iii. Sufficient in number for the maximum number of staff; iv. Constructed so that they can be easily cleaned and maintained; v. Include an area inside or nearby, for storing protective clothing, outer garments and other items while using the facilities; and vi. Kept clean and tidy.

**Response:** Compliant

**11.3.9.2** - Sanitary drainage shall not be connected to any other drains within the premises and shall be directed to a septic tank or a sewerage system in accordance in regulations.

**Response:** Compliant

**11.3.9.3** - Hand wash basins shall be provided immediately outside or inside the toilet room and designed as outlined in 11.3.2.2.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** A stainless steel handwash basin is strategically installed at all entrance points leading into the facility. Each station is fully equipped with warm running water, liquid soap, single-use paper towels, trash receptacles, and clearly posted handwashing signage to support proper hygiene practices. During the audit, employees consistently demonstrated compliance with required handwashing protocols. Personnel were observed washing their hands prior to entering the processing area and again prior to donning gloves. In all food-contact areas, employees wore appropriate gloves, and glove-use practices aligned with established procedures. Mandatory handwash signs were clearly posted in all restrooms, reinforcing hygiene expectations and supporting ongoing compliance.

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#### 11.3.10 - Lunch Rooms

**11.3.10.1** - Separate lunch room facilities shall be provided away from a food contact/handling zone.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** The lunchroom is physically separated from the production area to prevent cross-contamination and ensure employees do not bring food or personal items into food-handling zones.

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#### 11.4.1 - Staff Engaged in Food Handling and Processing Operations

**11.4.1.1** - All personnel engaged in any food handling, preparation or processing operations shall ensure that products and materials are handled and stored in such a way as to prevent damage or product contamination. They shall comply with the following processing practices: i. Personnel entry to processing areas shall be through the personnel access doors only; ii. All doors are to be kept closed. Doors shall not be left open for extended periods when access for waste removal or receiving of product/ingredient/packaging is required; iii. Packaging material, product, and ingredients shall be kept in appropriate containers as required and off the floor; iv. Waste shall be contained in the bins identified for this purpose and removed from the processing area on a regular basis and not left to accumulate; v. Staff shall not eat or taste any product being processed in the food handling/contact zone, except as noted in element 11.4.1.2; vi. The wearing of false fingernails, false eyelashes, eyelash extensions, long nails or fingernail polish is not permitted when handling exposed food; and vii. Hair restraints are used where product is exposed.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.4.1.2** - In circumstances where it is necessary to undertake sensory evaluations in a food handling/contact zone the site shall implement proper controls and procedures to ensure: i. Food safety is not compromised; ii. Sensory evaluations are conducted by authorized personnel only; iii. A high standard of personal hygiene is practiced by personnel conducting sensory evaluations; iv. Sensory evaluations are conducted in areas equipped for the purpose; and v. Equipment used for sensory evaluations is sanitized, maintained and stored separate from processing equipment.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.4.1.3** - All wash down hoses shall be stored on hose racks after use and not left on the floor.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** All personnel engaged in food handling, processing, or preparation activities were observed to manage products, ingredients, and packaging materials in a controlled manner that prevented damage and minimized contamination risk. Staff consistently demonstrated appropriate handling techniques and maintained hygienic practices throughout operations. No instances of eating, drinking, chewing gum, or tobacco use were observed in or around processing or warehouse areas, indicating strong adherence to facility hygiene policies. Employee movement was effectively controlled to reduce the potential for cross-contamination. Flow patterns were strategically managed, ensuring personnel transitioned between zones in accordance with established traffic-control requirements and food safety standards.

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### 11.5.1 - Water Supply

**11.5.1.1** - Adequate supplies of hot and cold potable water drawn from a known clean source shall be provided for use during processing operations, as an ingredient and for cleaning the premises and equipment.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.5.1.2** - The delivery of water within the premises shall ensure potable water is not contaminated.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 11.5.1 Water, Ice, and Air Supply Rev. 3/16/2026. The 2025 city water report was reviewed, and all results were found to be acceptable. In addition to municipal oversight, the site's water is tested by an independent accredited laboratory (Microbac). Routine testing includes analysis for total coliform and E. coli. Results reviewed from 11/20/2025 were acceptable and confirmed the potability of the water supply.

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### 11.5.2 - Water Treatment

**11.5.2.1** - Water treatment methods, equipment and materials, if required, shall be designed, installed and operated to ensure water receives an effective treatment.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not perform water treatment.

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**11.5.2.2** - Water treatment equipment shall be monitored regularly to ensure it remains serviceable.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not perform water treatment.

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**11.5.2.3** - Treated water shall be regularly monitored to ensure it meets the indicators specified.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not perform water treatment.

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**11.5.2.4** - Water used in as an ingredient in processing, or in cleaning and sanitizing equipment, shall be tested, and if required, treated to maintain potability (refer to 11.5.2.1).

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not perform water treatment.

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#### Summary -

**Response:** The site does not perform water treatment.

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### 11.5.3 - Ice Supply

**11.5.3.1** - Ice provided for use during processing operations or as a processing aid or an ingredient shall comply with 11.5.4.1.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not use ice.

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**11.5.3.2** - Ice rooms and receptacles shall be constructed of materials as outlined in elements 11.2.1, 11.2.2 and 11.2.3 and designed to minimize contamination of the ice during storage and distribution.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not use ice.

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#### Summary -

**Response:** The site does not use ice.

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### 11.5.4 - Monitoring Water Microbiology Quality

**11.5.4.1** - Water shall comply with local, national or internationally recognized potable water microbiological and quality standards as required when used for i. washing, thawing and treating food; ii. handwashing; iii. to convey food; iv. as an ingredient or food processing aid; v. cleaning food contact surfaces and equipment; vi. the manufacture of ice; or vii. the manufacture of steam that will come into contact with food or used to heat water that will come in contact with food.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** Water is not used as a processing aid at the site. Microbiological testing results for the facility's potable water supply were acceptable, with no pathogens or indicator organisms detected. Testing confirmed compliance with potability requirements. The site does not utilize ice in any aspect of its operations, eliminating associated contamination risks and related control requirements.

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### 11.5.5 - The Quality of Air and Other Gases

**11.5.5.1** - Compressed air or other gasses (e.g. nitrogen, carbon dioxide) that contacts food or food contact surfaces shall be clean and present no risk to food safety.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.5.5.2** - Compressed air systems, and systems used to store or dispense other gasses used in the manufacturing process that come into contact with food or food contact surfaces shall be maintained and regularly monitored for quality and applicable food safety hazards.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** The site conducts annual ambient air testing as part of its environmental monitoring and facility

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hygiene verification program. Testing is performed by Tri Air LLC, an independent laboratory. Results reviewed for mold and yeast from sampling conducted on 10/30/2025 were acceptable, with no concerns noted.

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#### 11.6.1 - Storage and Handling of Goods

**11.6.1.1** - The site shall document and implement an effective storage plan that allows for the safe, hygienic storage of raw materials (i.e. frozen, chilled, and ambient), ingredients, packaging materials, equipment, and chemicals.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.6.1.2** - The responsibility and methods for ensuring effective stock rotation principles are applied shall be documented and implemented.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.6.1.3** - Procedures shall be in place to ensure that all ingredients, materials, work-in-progress, rework, and finished product are utilized within their designated shelf-life.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.6.1.4** - Equipment storage rooms shall be designed and constructed to allow for the hygienic and efficient storage of equipment and containers.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.6.1.5** - Records shall be available to validate alternate or temporary control measures for the storage of raw materials, ingredients, packaging materials, equipment, chemicals, or finished products.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** SOP 11.6.1 Receipt, Storage and Handling of Goods Rev. 3/16/2026. Items are stored exclusively in designated storage areas within the facility, and no alternative or temporary storage locations are used. Raw materials and packaging components are organized to prevent contamination, ensure proper segregation, and facilitate accurate traceability. All raw materials and components are verified at the time of receipt in accordance with established receiving procedures. The Warehouse Manager is responsible for stock rotation, which is consistently managed using the First-In, First-Out (FIFO) method to maintain product integrity and support appropriate shelf-life management. Weekly stock checks are conducted to verify proper rotation.

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#### 11.6.2 - Cold Storage, Freezing and Chilling of Foods

**11.6.2.1** - Chillers, blast freezers and cold storage rooms shall be designed and constructed to allow for the hygienic and efficient refrigeration of food and easily accessible for inspection and cleaning.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not conduct any cold storage, freezing, or chilling of foods. All materials handled at the facility are ambient, shelf-stable, and no temperature-controlled processes or equipment are used.

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**11.6.2.2** - Sufficient refrigeration shall be available to chill, freeze, store chilled or store frozen the maximum anticipated throughput of product with allowance for periodic cleaning of refrigerated areas.

**Response:** N/A

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**Evidence:** • The site does not conduct any cold storage, freezing, or chilling of foods. All materials handled at the facility are ambient, shelf-stable, and no temperature-controlled processes or equipment are used.

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**11.6.2.3** - Discharge from defrost and condensate lines shall be controlled and discharged to the drainage system.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not conduct any cold storage, freezing, or chilling of foods. All materials handled at the facility are ambient, shelf-stable, and no temperature-controlled processes or equipment are used.

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**11.6.2.4** - Freezing, chilling and cold storage rooms shall be fitted with temperature monitoring equipment and located to monitor the warmest part of the room and be fitted with a temperature measurement device that is easily readable and accessible.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not conduct any cold storage, freezing, or chilling of foods. All materials handled at the facility are ambient, shelf-stable, and no temperature-controlled processes or equipment are used.

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**11.6.2.5** - Loading and unloading docks shall be designed to protect the product during loading and unloading.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not conduct any cold storage, freezing, or chilling of foods. All materials handled at the facility are ambient, shelf-stable, and no temperature-controlled processes or equipment are used.

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#### Summary -

**Response:** The site does not conduct any cold storage, freezing, or chilling of foods. All materials handled at the facility are ambient, shelf-stable, and no temperature-controlled processes or equipment are used.

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### 11.6.3 - Storage of Dry Ingredients, Packaging, and Shelf Stable Packaged Goods

**11.6.3.1** - Rooms used for the storage of product ingredients, packaging, and other dry goods shall be located away from wet areas and constructed to protect the product from contamination and deterioration.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.6.3.2** - Racks provided for the storage of packaging shall be constructed of impervious materials and designed to enable cleaning of the floors and the storage room. Storage areas shall be constructed to prevent packaging from becoming a harborage for pests or vermin.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.6.3.3** - Vehicles used in food contact, handling or processing zones or in cold storage rooms shall be designed and operated so as not to present a food safety hazard.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** All packaging is properly stored on racks or pallets. Dry goods are stored on pallets and on racks.

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### 11.6.4 - Storage of Hazardous Chemicals and Toxic Substances

**11.6.4.1** - Hazardous chemicals and toxic substances with the potential for food contamination shall be stored so as not to present a hazard to staff, product, packaging, product handling equipment or areas in which the product is handled, stored or transported.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** Hazardous chemicals are stored in a locked container within the warehouse, with access restricted to authorized personnel. Safety Data Sheets (SDS) for each chemical are readily available to support safe handling and emergency response. The site maintains an Approved Chemical List to ensure that only authorized chemicals are stored or used on-site.

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### 11.6.5 - Loading, Transport and Unloading Practices

**11.6.5.1** - The practices applied during loading, transport and unloading of food shall be documented, implemented and designed to maintain appropriate storage conditions and product integrity. Foods shall be loaded, transported and unloaded under conditions suitable to prevent cross contamination.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** Loading and unloading practices are established and implemented to ensure product and packaging integrity is maintained throughout transport. These practices also ensure that transport conditions prevent cross-contamination. All vehicles and trailers undergo visual inspections prior to loading to verify they are clean, in good condition, free of odors or debris, and suitable for transporting food products. Shipments are primarily conducted as LTL, and trailers are typically locked to maintain security and product protection during transit.

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### 11.6.6 - Loading

**11.6.6.1** - Vehicles (e.g. trucks/vans/containers) used for transporting food shall be inspected prior to loading to ensure they are clean, in good repair, suitable for the purpose and free from odors or other conditions that may impact negatively on the product.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.6.6.2** - Loading practices shall be designed to minimize unnecessary exposure of the product to conditions detrimental to maintaining the product and package integrity during loading and transport.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.6.6.3** - Vehicles (e.g. trucks/vans/containers) shall be secured from tampering using a seal or other agreed upon, acceptable device or system.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 11.6.6 Loading Rev. 3/16/2026. The site's shipments are primarily Less-Than-Truckload (LTL) and are commonly transported alongside other customers' products. All outbound loads follow established shipping and documentation procedures to ensure product protection, segregation, and traceability throughout transport.

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### 11.6.7 - Transport

**11.6.7.1** - Refrigerated units shall maintain the food at required temperatures and the unit's temperature settings

shall be set, checked and recorded before loading and product temperatures recorded at regular intervals during loading as appropriate.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • All site ingredients are shelf-stable and do not require refrigeration at any stage of receipt, storage, or use. No temperature-controlled storage, handling, or processing is needed to maintain ingredient safety or quality.

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**11.6.7.2** - The refrigeration unit shall be operational at all times and checks completed of the unit's operation, the door seals and the storage temperature checked at regular intervals during transit.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • All site ingredients are shelf-stable and do not require refrigeration at any stage of receipt, storage, or use. No temperature-controlled storage, handling, or processing is needed to maintain ingredient safety or quality.

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#### Summary -

**Response:** All site ingredients are shelf-stable and do not require refrigeration at any stage of receipt, storage, or use. No temperature-controlled storage, handling, or processing is needed to maintain ingredient safety or quality.

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### 11.6.8 - Unloading

**11.6.8.1** - Prior to opening the doors, the refrigeration unit's storage temperature settings and operating temperature shall be checked and recorded. Unloading shall be completed efficiently and product temperatures shall be recorded at the commencement of unloading and at regular intervals during unloading.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • All site ingredients are shelf-stable and do not require refrigeration at any stage of receipt, storage, or use. No temperature-controlled storage, handling, or processing is needed to maintain ingredient safety or quality.

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**11.6.8.2** - Unloading practices shall be designed to minimize unnecessary exposure of the product to conditions detrimental to maintaining the product and package integrity.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • All site ingredients are shelf-stable and do not require refrigeration at any stage of receipt, storage, or use. No temperature-controlled storage, handling, or processing is needed to maintain ingredient safety or quality.

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#### Summary -

**Response:** All site ingredients are shelf-stable and do not require refrigeration at any stage of receipt, storage, or use. No temperature-controlled storage, handling, or processing is needed to maintain ingredient safety or quality.

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### 11.7.1 - Process Flow

**11.7.1.1** - The process flow shall be designed to prevent cross contamination and organized so there is a continuous flow of product through the process. The flow of personnel shall be managed such that the potential for contamination is minimized.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 11.7.1 Process Flow Rev. 3/16/2026. The blend room, warehouse, and fulfillment area are physically separated to reduce the risk of cross-contact between raw ingredients and other materials. This segregation supports controlled product flow, minimizes contamination risks, and maintains compliance with established food safety and allergen-control requirements.

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### 11.7.2 - Receipt of Raw and Packaging Materials and Ingredients

**11.7.2.1** - Dry ingredients and packaging shall be received and stored separately from frozen and chilled raw materials to ensure there is no cross contamination. Unprocessed raw materials shall be received and segregated to ensure there is no cross contamination.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 11.7.2 Receipt of Raw and Packaging Materials and Ingredients Rev. 3/16/2026. All raw materials and components are verified at the time of receipt in accordance with established receiving procedures. The site does not receive any chilled raw materials or unprocessed/raw agricultural commodities. All materials handled are ambient, shelf-stable, and require no temperature-controlled storage or processing.

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### 11.7.3 - Thawing of Food

**11.7.3.1** - Thawing of food shall be undertaken in equipment and rooms appropriate for the purpose.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • There is no thawing process conducted at this site. All materials handled are ambient and shelf-stable, and no frozen ingredients are received or used that would require thawing controls or monitoring.

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**11.7.3.2** - Equipment for water thawing shall be continuous flow to ensure the water exchange rate and temperature does not contribute to product deterioration or contamination. Water overflow shall be directed into the floor drainage system and not onto the floor.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • There is no thawing process conducted at this site. All materials handled are ambient and shelf-stable, and no frozen ingredients are received or used that would require thawing controls or monitoring.

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**11.7.3.3** - Air thawing facilities shall be designed to thaw food under controlled conditions at a rate and temperature that does not contribute to product deterioration or contamination.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • There is no thawing process conducted at this site. All materials handled are ambient and shelf-stable, and no frozen ingredients are received or used that would require thawing controls or monitoring.

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**11.7.3.4** - Provision is to be made for the containment and regular disposal of used cartons and packaging from thawed product so that there is no risk to the product.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • There is no thawing process conducted at this site. All materials handled are ambient and shelf-stable, and no frozen ingredients are received or used that would require thawing controls or monitoring.

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**Summary -**

**Response:** There is no thawing process conducted at this site. All materials handled are ambient and shelf-stable, and no frozen ingredients are received or used that would require thawing controls or monitoring.

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#### 11.7.4 - High Risk Processes

**11.7.4.1** - The processing of high risk food shall be conducted under controlled conditions such that sensitive areas in which high risk food has undergone a “kill” step, a “food safety intervention” or is subject to post process handling, are protected/segregated from other processes, raw materials or staff who handle raw materials to ensure cross contamination is minimized.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not conduct any high-risk processes. All operations are limited to low-risk, controlled, and fully documented activities, with no thermal processing, kill-step validations, chemical treatments, or other activities requiring specialized controls.

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**11.7.4.2** - Areas in which high risk processes are conducted shall only be serviced by staff dedicated to that function.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not conduct any high-risk processes. All operations are limited to low-risk, controlled, and fully documented activities, with no thermal processing, kill-step validations, chemical treatments, or other activities requiring specialized controls.

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**11.7.4.3** - Staff access points shall be located, designed and equipped to enable staff to don distinctive protective clothing and to practice a high standard of personal hygiene to prevent product contamination.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not conduct any high-risk processes. All operations are limited to low-risk, controlled, and fully documented activities, with no thermal processing, kill-step validations, chemical treatments, or other activities requiring specialized controls.

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**11.7.4.4** - Staff engaged in high risk areas shall change into clean clothing or temporary protective outerwear when entering high risk areas.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The site does not conduct any high-risk processes. All operations are limited to low-risk, controlled, and fully documented activities, with no thermal processing, kill-step validations, chemical treatments, or other activities requiring specialized controls.

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**11.7.4.5** - Product transfer points shall be located and designed so as not to compromise high risk segregation and to minimize the risk of cross contamination.

**Response:** N/A

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**Evidence:** • The site does not conduct any high-risk processes. All operations are limited to low-risk, controlled, and fully documented activities, with no thermal processing, kill-step validations, chemical treatments, or other activities requiring specialized controls.

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**Summary -**

**Response:** The site does not conduct any high-risk processes. All operations are limited to low-risk, controlled, and fully documented activities, with no thermal processing, kill-step validations, chemical treatments, or other activities requiring specialized controls.

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### 11.7.5 - Control of Foreign Matter Contamination

**11.7.5.1** - The responsibility and methods used to prevent foreign matter contamination of the product shall be documented, implemented and communicated to all staff.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.7.5.2** - Inspections shall be performed to ensure plant and equipment remains in good condition, equipment has not become detached or deteriorated and is free from potential contaminants.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.7.5.3** - All glass objects or similar material in food handling/contact zones shall be listed in a glass register including details of their location.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.7.5.4** - Containers, equipment and other utensils made of glass, porcelain, ceramics, laboratory glassware or other like material (except where the product is contained in packaging made from these materials, or measurement instruments with glass dial covers or MIG thermometers required under regulation) shall not be permitted in food processing /contact zones.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.7.5.5** - Regular inspections of food handling/contact zones shall be conducted to ensure they are free of glass or other like material and to establish changes to the condition of the objects listed in the glass register.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.7.5.6** - Glass instrument dial covers on processing equipment and MIG thermometers shall be inspected at the start of each shift to confirm they have not been damaged.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.7.5.7** - Wooden pallets and other wooden utensils used in food handling/contact zones shall be dedicated for that purpose, clean, maintained in good order. Their condition shall be subject to regular inspection.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.7.5.8** - Loose metal objects on equipment, equipment covers and overhead structures shall be removed or tightly fixed so as not to present a hazard.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.7.5.9** - Knives and cutting instruments used in processing and packaging operations shall be controlled, and kept clean and well maintained. Snap-off blades shall not be used in manufacturing or storage areas.



**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 11.7.5 Control of Foreign Contamination Rev. 3/16/2026. The site's foreign material control policy includes comprehensive glass, brittle plastic, wood, and knife controls. Use of wood is restricted in production areas, and only approved wood pallets are permitted for packed product. All wood pallets must undergo an inspection prior to use, and the finished product is separated with a pallet layer card to prevent contact and reduce contamination risk. Knives and cutting tools are controlled under the site's knife management program, and no unauthorized blades are permitted in production areas. Snap off blades are not allowed in the production areas. Foreign material checks are incorporated into daily pre-operational inspections, verifying equipment integrity, absence of loose components, and compliance with glass/wood/knife controls. The most recent Glass, Brittle Plastic, Knife, and Wood Audit, dated 2/9/2026, was reviewed and found to be acceptable.

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#### 11.7.6 - Detection of Foreign Objects

**11.7.6.1** - The responsibility, methods and frequency for monitoring, maintaining, calibrating and using screens, sieves, filters or other technologies to remove or detect foreign matter shall be documented and implemented.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.7.6.2** - Metal detectors or other physical contaminant detection technologies shall be routinely monitored, validated and verified for operational effectiveness. The equipment shall be designed to isolate defective product and indicate when it is rejected.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.7.6.3** - Records shall be maintained of the inspection of foreign object detection devices and of any products rejected or removed by them. Records shall include any corrective actions resulting from the inspections.

**Response:** Compliant

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**Summary -**

**Response:** SOP 11.7.6 Detection of Foreign Objects Rev. 3/4/2026. Product is manually handled and scooped during processing and packaging. Employees are trained to visually inspect product for foreign materials at all stages of production, and observations during the audit confirmed consistent adherence to these practices. As part of the site's foreign material prevention program, all equipment is inspected during daily preoperational checks to verify that it is intact, properly assembled, and free of any loose or damaged parts that could pose a contamination risk.

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#### 11.7.7 - Managing Foreign Matter Contamination Incidents

**11.7.7.1** - In all cases of foreign matter contamination the affected batch or item shall be isolated, inspected, reworked or disposed of.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.7.7.2** - In circumstances where glass or similar material breakage occurs, the affected area is to be isolated, cleaned and thoroughly inspected (including cleaning equipment and footwear) and cleared by a suitably responsible person prior to the commencement of operations.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** In the event of material breakage, the cleanup is supervised by the SQFP to ensure proper foreign material control. All utensils used during the cleanup are immediately discarded to prevent contamination risks.

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#### 11.8.1 - Location

**11.8.1.1** - On site laboratories conducting chemical and microbiological analysis that may pose a risk to product safety, shall be located separate from any food processing or handling activity and designed to limit access only to authorized personnel.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The facility does not have an onsite laboratory. All required testing is performed by approved independent laboratories in accordance with the site's verification and monitoring programs.

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**11.8.1.2** - Provisions shall be made to isolate and contain all laboratory waste held on the premises and manage it separately from food waste. Laboratory waste water outlet shall as a minimum be down stream of drains that service food processing and handling areas.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The facility does not have an onsite laboratory. All required testing is performed by approved independent laboratories in accordance with the site's verification and monitoring programs.

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**11.8.1.3** - Signage shall be displayed identifying the laboratory area as a restricted area accessible only by authorized personnel.

**Response:** N/A

**Evidence:** • The facility does not have an onsite laboratory. All required testing is performed by approved independent laboratories in accordance with the site's verification and monitoring programs.

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#### Summary -

**Response:** The facility does not have an onsite laboratory. All required testing is performed by approved independent laboratories in accordance with the site's verification and monitoring programs.

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#### 11.9.1 - Dry and Liquid Waste Disposal

**11.9.1.1** - The responsibility and methods used to collect and handle dry, wet and liquid waste and store prior to removal from the premises shall be documented and implemented.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.9.1.2** - Waste shall be removed on a regular basis and not build up in food handling or processing areas. Designated waste accumulation areas shall be maintained in a clean and tidy condition until external waste collection is undertaken.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** The site does not generate liquid waste as part of its operations. All waste produced is dry waste, which is collected and removed by an independent waste management company on a weekly schedule. Waste is contained in designated bins and removed routinely to prevent accumulation and eliminate contamination

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risks within the facility.

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#### 11.10.1 - Grounds and Roadways

**11.10.1.1** - The grounds and area surrounding the premises shall be maintained to minimize dust and kept free of waste, accumulated debris or standing water so as not to attract pests and vermin.

**Response:** Compliant

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**11.10.1.2** - Paths, roadways and loading and unloading areas shall be maintained so as not to present a hazard to the food safety operation of the premises.

**Response:** Compliant

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#### Summary -

**Response:** No pooling of water was observed around the facility. Amenities and access points leading to facility entrances showed no issues that could impact hygiene or pest control. Vegetation was well-controlled, and all paths and walkways on the premises were clear of obstruction, supporting safe movement and effective site maintenance. The parking area is asphalt, with clearly marked parking spaces, and was observed to be clean, orderly, and in good repair.

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